

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Salhin Langhi

Address: 3 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:Re: Planning Application DM2025/01591

I am writing to express my strong support for Planning Application DM2025/01591.

I am 28 years old and have grown up in Belmont, spending my childhood and early adult life in the immediate vicinity of this site. I attended The Avenue Primary School and later Overton Grange School, and much of my upbringing was rooted in this neighbourhood. Having lived here for nearly three decades, with close family still based locally, I remain deeply connected to the area and continue to participate in community life. This longstanding connection gives me a clear understanding of both the character of Belmont and the needs of its residents.

From my perspective as someone who grew up locally, a community-focused facility of this kind would have been incredibly beneficial to many young people in the area. The proposed change of use from the former ambulance station (Sui Generis) to a mixed-use facility under Classes F1 (Place of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) represents a thoughtful and positive evolution of the site. Rather than remaining underutilised, the building would become a place that actively serves and brings together the local community.

The plans outline a range of clear social benefits, including wellbeing initiatives, youth education programmes, and wider community activities accessible to all residents. Of particular importance is the provision of dedicated space and structured activities for women, offering a secure and supportive environment for engagement and personal development. The youth-focused elements are equally valuable, providing mentorship, guidance, and constructive opportunities that can help

foster confidence, discipline, and stronger community ties.

In terms of design and scale, the proposed extensions appear proportionate and respectful of the surrounding residential context. The part one, part two-storey additions and modest height increase do not seem excessive for the plot and are consistent with the character of nearby buildings. It is also worth noting that the intensity of use associated with this proposal is comparatively modest when considering alternative redevelopment possibilities for the site.

Traffic and parking considerations have clearly been addressed within the application. The inclusion of 12 on-site parking spaces, including disabled bays, alongside cycle storage and encouragement of sustainable travel, reflects careful planning. The proposed staggering of Friday prayer times to avoid overlap with nearby school pick-up periods demonstrates awareness of local patterns and a willingness to mitigate potential congestion. Overall, I do not believe the development would create unreasonable levels of noise, traffic, or disturbance beyond what is typical for a community facility.

I am also pleased to see that landscaping and greenery are being retained, ensuring the development integrates sympathetically into the surrounding streetscape rather than appearing overly dense.

Having seen Belmont evolve over the years, I believe this proposal would provide meaningful, long-term benefits. It would offer structured support for young people, inclusive space for residents of all backgrounds, and opportunities that strengthen connections across the community.

For these reasons, I respectfully urge the Council to approve Planning Application DM2025/01591.